Ishan Shah

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Engineering Leader | AI-Driven Engineering, Platform & Production Infrastructure at Scale | Distributed Systems, SRE/Reliability & Kubernetes

SUMMARY

Engineering leader with 15+ years leading platform, infrastructure, and production-engineering teams that build and operate large-scale distributed systems. I champion AI adoption across the software development lifecycle and design and deploy AI agents that automate engineering workflows — while owning the reliability, scalability, security, and cost of cloud infrastructure. I run Kubernetes across multiple clouds with infrastructure-as-code, comprehensive observability, SLOs, and blameless incident response at 99.99% uptime, and I've operated one of AWS's largest-scale distributed data services. I hire, mentor, and grow high-performing engineers, foster a culture of operational excellence, and partner across product, security, and AI-infrastructure teams while communicating clearly to executives. Hands-on in Python and Java.

EXPERIENCE

CruxOCM Inc. — VP of Engineering / Head of Automation (reporting to the CTO) · Feb 2025 – Present

- **Team leadership & operational excellence:** Lead a distributed engineering org across platform, infrastructure, DevOps, SRE, security, and quality; hire, mentor, and grow engineers and leads, run hiring and budgets, and foster a culture of operational excellence, ownership, and continuous improvement; partner cross-functionally with product, security, and AI-infrastructure teams and communicate to executives.
- **AI across the SDLC & agents that automate engineering:** Champion AI adoption across the development lifecycle — an org-wide Gemini Enterprise rollout, standardized Cursor/Claude Code + GitHub Copilot for automated PR review — and designed and deployed production AI agents on GCP ADK (miniBOT, a Gemini multi-agent assistant; TestBOT, which auto-generates tests) plus reusable MCP servers that automate engineering workflows.
- **Production infrastructure & Kubernetes:** Standardized Kubernetes as the control plane across GCP and Azure — cluster provisioning, upgrades, monitoring, and reliability — with multi-tenant, GitOps-governed clusters and Terraform infrastructure-as-code and automation frameworks; own production operations for a safety-critical platform.
- **Reliability, observability & cost:** Run reliability with observability (Grafana LGTM — metrics, logs, traces — / OpenObserve, PagerDuty), SLOs, and blameless incident response and RCA at 99.99% uptime; drive capacity planning and infrastructure cost optimization, owning ~$2M cloud spend with >$200K saved.
- **Distributed systems, CI/CD & continuous delivery:** Own CI/CD and continuous delivery across GitHub Actions, Jenkins, Bazel (monorepo), and Gradle on AWS/GCP with pipeline gating and release governance; drive engineering productivity as DORA metrics with dashboards from engineer to executive.
- **Infrastructure security & compliance:** Build secure infrastructure foundations — identity/access management, encrypted secrets, and access-control standards — and spearheaded ISO 27001 and SOC 2 programs (audit ownership) with SBOM and static-analysis scanning.

Insulet Corporation (FDA-regulated medical devices) — Sr. Cloud Engineering Manager · Dec 2022 – Feb 2025

- Led cloud and data-product teams (25–30 engineers) across platform, DevOps, developer productivity, and performance engineering; partnered with the VP of Engineering on multi-year roadmaps and quarterly OKRs.
- Built a performance and load-testing framework (Locust, Python) on EKS/AWS (25% improvement); operated highly available Jenkins on EKS/EFS (99.9% uptime) and cut deployment errors 15%.
- Owned end-to-end CI/CD with gating and one-button deploy (Jenkins, Python, Gradle); implemented SBOM generation and regulated change control for data integrity and supply-chain security.

Amazon (AWS Redshift) — Lead Systems Engineer · Dec 2016 – Dec 2022

- Owned the build, CI/CD, release ecosystem, and test tooling for Redshift — one of AWS's largest-scale distributed data services — including the CI/CD servers and fully automated build/deploy across all AWS-supported regions.
- Led the team that designed and shipped a Bors-style automated merge queue, gating integration on the exact merge candidate (not just the feature branch) — eliminating broken-mainline incidents and unblocking developer velocity org-wide.

- Added metrics-driven reporting on pipeline health and developer productivity, making bottlenecks visible and driving continuous improvement across the developer workflow.

Prosper Marketplace (regulated fintech) — Lead DevOps Engineer · Jan 2015 – Dec 2016

- Rolled out org-wide CI/CD with Jenkins and containerization with Docker; managed Artifactory artifact/versioning, SonarQube static-analysis quality gates, and a Hadoop cluster on AWS (EMR).

Pivotal Software — Member of Technical Staff · Sep 2011 – Jan 2015

- Managed CI infrastructure and agents; migrated Perforce to Git with enforced branching/merge policy; automated Coverity static analysis and code-coverage; built dynamic provisioning of Linux environments on AWS and vCloud.

OPEN SOURCE

UniClaw · github.com/uniclaw-labs/uniclaw

- Architected and shipped UniClaw, an open-source AI agent platform — Claude-powered agents on a FastAPI (Python) backend and a React / TypeScript app, with a pluggable provider/tool registry (27+ integrations) and a security-first design (OAuth2 authorization server with scoped JWTs, rate limiting, Fernet-encrypted secrets, non-root containers); 4,400+ automated tests across a polyglot codebase (Python, TypeScript, Rust). Also publish an open-source Lever MCP server.

EDUCATION

- M.S., Software Engineering, San Jose State University (2011)
- B.E., Computer Engineering, Gujarat University (2009)

SKILLS & TOOLS

- **AI Engineering:** Champion AI across the SDLC; AI agents (GCP ADK) that automate engineering workflows; MCP servers; RAG / retrieval (Vertex AI); enterprise AI rollout (Gemini Enterprise); AI-assisted development (Cursor, Claude Code, GitHub Copilot); generative-AI integration
- **Production Infrastructure & Platform:** Kubernetes (EKS, GKE, AKS) — cluster lifecycle, upgrades, reliability; multi-tenant clusters; Terraform (IaC); Docker; GitOps; capacity planning; fleet & cost optimization
- **Reliability & SRE:** Observability (Grafana LGTM / OpenObserve, PagerDuty) — monitoring, logging, alerting; SLOs; incident response & blameless RCA; 99.99% reliability; production operations
- **Distributed Systems & Delivery:** Large-scale distributed systems; CI/CD & continuous delivery (GitHub Actions, Jenkins, Bazel monorepo, Gradle) on AWS/GCP/Azure; REST / API design; agile/scrum; DORA metrics
- **Security & Compliance:** IAM & access control; encrypted secrets; network isolation; ISO 27001 / SOC 2 (audit ownership); SBOM & static-analysis scanning
- **Leadership:** Hiring, mentoring & growing high-performing teams; cross-functional & executive partnership; roadmaps & OKRs; ~$2–3M budget & vendor management
- **Languages & Data:** Python; Java; Bash; C/C#; React / TypeScript; SQL/NoSQL (MySQL, PostgreSQL, Oracle, DynamoDB)